

HISTORY

Overview

The History department offers Bachelor of Arts and Bachelor of Science degrees in History and a Master of Arts degree in History. Many history majors also pursue a minor in another discipline, a second major, or secondary teacher certification.

The department offers a variety of survey courses (2000 series) for first- and second-year students as either general education courses or as introductions to advanced courses in history or other subject areas. In addition to 2000-level survey courses, it offers advanced undergraduate courses in the history of Europe, Asia, Africa, Latin America, the United States, technology and science, agriculture, and other selected topics.

Student Learning Outcomes

Upon graduation, students should be able to:

1. Display the appropriate level of cognitive knowledge of historical themes and events based upon the student's course of study.
2. Display an understanding of past cultures and social organizations, based on the course of study.
3. Develop the fundamental methodological skills of the historical craft: the ability to contextualize and analyze primary source evidence; familiarity with the concepts of historical argument and interpretation, and the ability to formulate effective argumentation in written and oral forms; awareness of the basic historiography in selected research area; and the ability to conduct research and to write a historical essay based upon primary and secondary source research. Students receive an introduction to these concepts in HIST 3010 The Historian's Toolbox.
4. Display a sophisticated understanding of the relationship between past events and the present. For purposes of outcomes assessment, History majors must complete three credits from the following list: HIST 4950 Historiography and Research Writing; if qualified and willing, one graduate-level research seminar; or if qualified and pursuing teacher certification HIST 4980 Methods of Teaching History/Social Sciences.

Contact Information

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- **Department Website** – Link (<https://history.iastate.edu/>)

Program Administration

- **Owning Academic Unit/College** – College of Liberal Arts and Sciences
- **Coordinating Academic Unit/ Department** – History Department

Credential Opportunities

- **Program Duration** – 4 years
- **Credential(s) Offered**
 - History, B.S. (120 credits)
 - History, B.A. (120 credits)
- **Program Focus Areas**
 - **History Teacher Preparation Undergraduate Program** – History majors seeking teacher certification in History/Social Sciences Education must meet all of the requirements of the History major while taking the specific History classes required for certification by the State of Iowa. Students must also meet the requirements of the Secondary Major in Education including student teaching. Students will earn a minimum grade of B- in all content courses used for licensure and a minimum grade of C in all other required courses. (39 credits)

- **Program Designation** – On-Campus Program

Requirements for the History Major

The B.S. in History requires a minimum 36 total credits of HIST with 2.0 GPA or higher *including*:

1. Maximum 12 credits at 2000-level HIST or below
2. Minimum 24 credits 3000+ level HIST *including*:
3. HIST 3010 (minimum grade C)
4. HIST 4950, HIST 4980, or HIST graduate-level research seminar (minimum grade C)
5. Maximum 12 credits 3000-level HIST in addition to HIST 3010
6. Minimum 9 credits 4000-level HIST in addition to HIST 4950, HIST 4980 or HIST graduate-level research seminar
7. Minimum 15 credits 3000+ level HIST taken at Iowa State University

Communication Proficiency requirement: History majors must receive a grade of C or better in ENGL 2500 (or ENGL 2500H), HIST 3010 and HIST 4950 or HIST 4980.

The B.A. in History requires the equivalent of 2 years of college-level study in the same world language. Six credits of electives may be replaced by 6 additional credits of world language.

Students in all ISU majors must complete a three-credit course in U.S. Cultures and Communities and a three-credit course in International Perspectives. Check (<http://www.registrar.iastate.edu/courses/div-ip-guide.html>) for a list of approved courses. Discuss with your advisor how the two courses that you select can be applied to your graduation plan.

LAS majors require a minimum of 120 credits, **including a minimum of 45 credits at the 3000/4000 level.** For a history major, 15 credits of history at the 3000/4000-level must be taken at ISU. You must also complete the LAS world language and career proficiency requirements (LAS 2030 Professional Career Preparation).

As majors in the College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, History students must meet College of Liberal Arts and Sciences (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofliberalartsandsciences/#lascollegerequirementstext>) and University-wide requirements (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegescurricula/>) for graduation in addition to those stated for the major.

Teacher Preparation Focus

History majors seeking teacher certification in History/Social Sciences Education must meet all of the requirements of the History major while taking the specific History classes required for certification by the State of Iowa. Students must also meet the requirements of the Secondary Major in Education (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/collegeofhumansciences/educationsecondary/#curriculumtext>) including student teaching. Students will complete the requirements below, earning a minimum grade of B- in all content courses used for licensure and a minimum grade of C in all other required courses.

Also, students complete the requirements for one additional fifteen-credit endorsement in Political Science, Psychology, Economics, Anthropology or Sociology. Specific requirements of each endorsement are available from the history department. Teacher license requirements are established by the Iowa Department of Education and the Iowa Board of Educational Examiners and are subject to change. Recent changes may not be reflected in this catalog, but advisers and faculty will be aware.

Requirements to complete endorsements in American History and World History.

HIST 2010	Introduction to Western Civilization I	3
HIST 2020	Introduction to Western Civilization II	3
One World History pre-1500		3
HIST 3040	Cultural Heritage of the Ancient World	
	or HIST 3310History of the Islamic World to 1800	
	or HIST 3320East Slavic, Eurasian, and Russian History to 1855	

or HIST 3740Sex, Gender, and Culture in the Ancient Mediterranean World

or HIST 3840Roman Italy: An Introduction

or HIST 3850Study Abroad: Roman Italy: Building the Empire

or HIST 4020Greek Civilization

or HIST 4030Roman Civilization

or HIST 4050Transformations of the Early Medieval World

or HIST 4060The Birth of Europe in the High Middle Ages

or HIST 4070Crises of the Late Middle Ages

One European World post-1500 3

HIST 3200 History of Modern Europe, 1789 to Present

or HIST 3250Society and Politics in England, 1525-1700

or HIST 3280History of Modern France

or HIST 3820History and Philosophy of the Scientific Revolution

or HIST 3830European Science, Technology, and Culture

or HIST 3900World Military History

or HIST 4100The Holocaust in History

or HIST 4140European Cultural and Intellectual History

or HIST 4200France's Revolutionary Century, 1715-1815

or HIST 4220History of Modern Russia

or HIST 4230The Russian and Soviet Mind, 1762-1991

or HIST 4240History of Modern Germany

or HIST 4270Crime and Policing in England 1550-1850

or HIST 4280Punishment, Mentalities, and Society in England, 1550-1868

or HIST 4310Modern England

or HIST 4890The World at War

One Non-European World post-1500 3

HIST 3100 Africa to 1880

or HIST 3110Colonialism and Independence in Africa

or HIST 3310History of the Islamic World to 1800

or HIST 3360Ancient China

or HIST 3370Modern China

or HIST 3400Colonial Latin America

or HIST 3410Modern Latin America

or HIST 4350History of the Modern Middle East

or HIST 4410History of Modern Mexico and Central America

or HIST 4420Rebellions and Revolutions in Latin America

or HIST 4790China and the Cold War

HIST 2210 Survey of United States History I 3

HIST 2220 Survey of United States History II 3

Nine additional credits of U.S. History at the 3000 level and above 9

HIST 3070 American Popular Culture

or HIST 3530History of African Americans I
 or HIST 3540History of African Americans II
 or HIST 3570American Family History
 or HIST 3630U. S. Environmental History
 or HIST 3650American Agriculture I: The Maya to McCormick's
 Reaper
 or HIST 3660American Agriculture II: Homestead Act to GMOs
 or HIST 3670America Eats
 or HIST 3700History of Iowa
 or HIST 3710Mexican American History
 or HIST 3720Latina/o History
 or HIST 3750U.S. Civil War and Reconstruction
 or HIST 3760U.S. Gilded Age and Progressive Era
 or HIST 3770Rise of a Modern America
 or HIST 3780Mid-Twentieth Century America
 or HIST 3800History of Women in Science, Technology, and
 Medicine
 or HIST 3860History of Women in America
 or HIST 3870First Ladies in U.S. History
 or HIST 3890American Military History
 or HIST 3910American Diplomatic History since 1898
 or HIST 4500Colonial America
 or HIST 4510American Revolutionary Era
 or HIST 4530American Legal History
 or HIST 4540Early American Republic
 or HIST 4570History of American Sexualities
 or HIST 4600The Great Plains
 or HIST 4610The American South
 or HIST 4650The American West
 or HIST 4730Civil Rights and Ethnic Power
 or HIST 4820Birth, Death, Medicine, and Disease
 or HIST 4880American Stuff, Colonial Times to the Present
 or HIST 4890The World at War

HIST 3010	The Historian's Toolbox	3
HIST 4980	Methods of Teaching History/Social Sciences	3
Total Credits		36

Complementary Coursework for History Social Studies Teacher
 Preparation

EDUC 4260	Principles of Secondary Education	3
PSYCH 2300	Developmental Psychology	3
POLS 1110	Introduction to American Government	3
POLS 1210	Introduction to International Politics	3

or POLS 1250 Democracy and Dictatorship: Introduction to
 Comparative Politics

Four Year Plans History, B.S.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 History Choice - 2000-Level	3
History Choice - 2000-Level	3 Natural Science Choice	3
Social Science Choice	3 Humanities Choice	3
Humanities Choice	3 Math Choice	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Social Science Choice	3
	LIB 1600	1
15		16

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 2500	3 HIST 3010	3
History Choice - 2000-3000-Level	3 History Choice - 2000/3000-Level	3
World Language/Elective	3-4 World Language/Elective	4
Humanities Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	2
Social Science Choice	3 Elective	3
LAS 2030	1	
16-17		15

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
History Choice - 3000/4000-Level	3 History Choice - 3000/4000-Level	3
History Choice - 3000/4000-Level	3 History Choice - 4000-Level	3
Elective	9 Elective	8
15		14

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
History Choice - 4000-Level	3 HIST 4950	3
History Choice - 4000-Level	3 Elective	11
Elective	9	
15		14

Total Credits: 120-121

History, B.A.

Freshman

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 1500	3 History Choice - 2000-Level	3
History Choice - 2000-Level	3 Math Choice	3
Humanities Choice	3 Humanities Choice	3
Natural Science Choice	3 Natural Science Choice	3
Social Science Choice	3 Social Science Choice	3
	LIB 1600	1
	15	16

Sophomore

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
ENGL 2500	3 HIST 3010	3
History Choice - 2000/3000-Level	3 History Choice - 2000/3000-Level	3
Elementary World Language - 1000-Level ¹	4 Social Science Choice	3
Humanities Choice	3 Elementary World Language - 1000-Level ¹	4
Elective	1 Natural Science Choice	2
LAS 2030	1	
	15	15

Junior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
History Choice - 3000/4000-Level	3 History Choice - 3000/4000-Level	3
History Choice - 3000/4000-Level	3 History Choice - 4000-Level	3
Interemmediate World Language - 2000-Level	4 Intermediate World Language - 2000-Level	4
Electives	5 Electives	4
	15	14

Senior

Fall	Credits Spring	Credits
History Choice - 4000-Level	3 HIST 4950	3
History Choice - 4000-Level	3 Electives	12
Electives	9	
	15	15

Total Credits: 120

¹ The BA in History requires the equivalent of 2 years of college-level study in the same world language. Six credits of electives may be replaced by 6 additional credits of world language.

Minor

The department offers an undergraduate minor in History. It is available to any student.

A minor in History requires 15 credits.

HIST 1000- to 4000-level courses	6
Plus 9 credits from the following list:	9

HIST 3040	Cultural Heritage of the Ancient World
HIST 3070	American Popular Culture
HIST 3100	Africa to 1880
HIST 3110	Colonialism and Independence in Africa
HIST 3180	History of Early Modern Europe, 1450-1789
HIST 3200	History of Modern Europe, 1789 to Present
HIST 3250	Society and Politics in England, 1525-1700
HIST 3270	History of the British Empire
HIST 3280	History of Modern France
HIST 3310	History of the Islamic World to 1800
HIST 3320	East Slavic, Eurasian, and Russian History to 1855
HIST 3360	Ancient China
HIST 3370	Modern China
HIST 3400	Colonial Latin America
HIST 3410	Modern Latin America
HIST 3500	History of Aviation
HIST 3530	History of African Americans I
HIST 3540	History of African Americans II
HIST 3570	American Family History
HIST 3630	U. S. Environmental History
HIST 3640	The Mythic Wild West
HIST 3650	American Agriculture I: The Maya to McCormick's Reaper
HIST 3660	American Agriculture II: Homestead Act to GMOs
HIST 3670	America Eats
HIST 3700	History of Iowa
HIST 3710	Mexican American History
HIST 3720	Latina/o History
HIST 3740	Sex, Gender, and Culture in the Ancient Mediterranean World
HIST 3750	U.S. Civil War and Reconstruction
HIST 3760	U.S. Gilded Age and Progressive Era
HIST 3770	Rise of a Modern America
HIST 3780	Mid-Twentieth Century America
HIST 3800	History of Women in Science, Technology, and Medicine

HIST 3820	History and Philosophy of the Scientific Revolution
HIST 3830	European Science, Technology, and Culture
HIST 3860	History of Women in America
HIST 3870	First Ladies in U.S. History
HIST 3890	American Military History
HIST 3900	World Military History
HIST 3910	American Diplomatic History since 1898
HIST 3960	Special Topics in History
HIST 4020	Greek Civilization
HIST 4030	Roman Civilization
HIST 4050	Transformations of the Early Medieval World
HIST 4060	The Birth of Europe in the High Middle Ages
HIST 4070	Crises of the Late Middle Ages
HIST 4100	The Holocaust in History
HIST 4140	European Cultural and Intellectual History
HIST 4200	France's Revolutionary Century, 1715-1815
HIST 4220	History of Modern Russia
HIST 4230	The Russian and Soviet Mind, 1762-1991
HIST 4240	History of Modern Germany
HIST 4270	Crime and Policing in England 1550-1850
HIST 4280	Punishment, Mentalities, and Society in England, 1550-1868
HIST 4310	Modern England
HIST 4350	History of the Modern Middle East
HIST 4410	History of Modern Mexico and Central America
HIST 4420	Rebellions and Revolutions in Latin America
HIST 4500	Colonial America
HIST 4510	American Revolutionary Era
HIST 4530	American Legal History
HIST 4540	Early American Republic
HIST 4570	History of American Sexualities
HIST 4600	The Great Plains
HIST 4610	The American South
HIST 4650	The American West
HIST 4730	Civil Rights and Ethnic Power
HIST 4790	China and the Cold War
HIST 4810	Public History
HIST 4820	Birth, Death, Medicine, and Disease
HIST 4880	American Stuff, Colonial Times to the Present
HIST 4890	The World at War
HIST 4960	Advanced Special Topics in History

Total Credits**15**

History is an LAS minor. In addition to University policies governing minors (<https://catalog.iastate.edu/academics/#degreeplanningtext>), LAS minors require at least 6 credits in courses numbered 3000 and above, with a grade of C or higher.

Graduate Study

The History Department offers an M.A. in History.

Most history graduate courses are either readings seminars or research seminars. Readings seminars acquaint students with the historical literature of a field and prepare them for careers in teaching and research. Research seminars require students to conduct original historical research and to write research papers reporting the results.

The M.A. in history includes both thesis and non-thesis options. See the departmental website on the M.A. in History for a full discussion of the options and requirements. An M.A. in History serves as the basis for continued study in history, as well as preparation for careers in law, education, business, and government service.